Yifan Zhu

AI Product Designer · From user research to live products

Glasgow, UK · Open to relocation
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Portfolio: yifan-zhu-portfolio-2026.netlify.app

Product designer focused on AI products. I research with the people involved, design the interaction, then build working products with AI-assisted development and ship them to real users.

SELECTED PRODUCTS

Screen Context Assistant — Solo: design, build and release — Sep – Oct 2026

Independent multimodal AI product · **Product guide / source**

- Designed the end-to-end interaction for a Windows AI tool that extracts, translates, explains and summarises anything on screen: task selection, region capture, input preview, waiting and error states, floating results, copying and isolated temporary sessions.
- Built it with AI-assisted implementation and **released it to 100+ users** under the MIT licence; fixed high-DPI capture offsets and tested the key flows before release.

Glasgow Salon Booking & Scheduling — Lead, product & service design (team of 2) — Oct 2026 – present

Live UK product · **Live booking** · **Case study**

- **Live since 21 October 2026** for a salon averaging **90–120 appointments and 70–80 visits a week** over six trading days. Led requirements, service blueprints, booking rules and the English/Chinese customer experience; collaborated on the owner interface and direct a classmate on follow-up research.
- Designed a **3-step booking flow and 4 admin entry points**, turning service duration, availability, bookings and closures into slot and status rules; validated **17 business scenarios**, including rescheduling, cancellation and closures.

LOOK — Solo product designer — Oct 2026

UK local styling platform · two-sided marketplace · **Case study / prototype**

- Designed a **work sample → creator → service** journey from a reference image to the right practitioner; delivered scope, information architecture and a runnable customer/creator prototype for quotes and booking requests.
- Gathered needs from Glasgow hair and beauty practitioners in person and over WhatsApp; built **portfolios for 40+ creators across 10+ local shops**, and demonstrated it to **100+ local people**.

Cyber Projection Toolkit — Solo: research, design, build and release — Jul – Aug 2026

Released commercial Blender add-on · **Case study / demo**

- Built from the comments and DMs on my Blender tutorials: followers wanted the effect but found the manual workflow too hard, so I packaged it into an add-on with adjustable effects and presets. Owned requirements, AI-assisted implementation, testing, release, demos and documentation.
- Part of a digital-resource catalogue I run, which reaches **600+ users and 2,000+ downloads/claims** across platforms (catalogue-wide figures, not this tool alone).

AIGC work — Solo: AI features, agent skills and generative workflows — 2026

- **Idea to Edit**: an AI feature concept for CapCut where one idea becomes an editable project and you regenerate only the part that feels wrong.
- **Storyboard Skill**: an agent skill that turns one sentence into a storyboard, with a different creative method for each kind of film. **Doodle to Real**: a ComfyUI workflow that turns a photo into marker doodles, then back into the real thing.

EXPERIENCE

Creative Planning & Content Design Intern · Institution Under Construction — Italy, remote · Aug 2026 – present

English-language collaboration · **Official project** · **Film course / guests**

- Produced course promotions featuring **50 international faculty**, including Hou Hanru, Charles Esche and Mieke Bal, for Course for Non-Curators; turned 8 course groups into visual themes and videos.
- Planned promotion for a film course with **13 international guests across 12 themes**, including Paolo Bertolin and Davide Ferrario; chose AI and design tools for each brief and ran a research → script/storyboard → visual production → review workflow.

SKILLS

Design	User research, interaction design, AI interaction states, information architecture, service blueprints, prototyping
Build with AI	Codex, Claude Code, ChatGPT, Git/GitHub, Python project practice, developer collaboration
Visual, 3D & AIGC	Blender (hand-built, modelling to render), Figma, Photoshop, SketchUp, AutoCAD; ComfyUI, Higgsfield
Languages	Chinese (native), English (professional working proficiency)

EDUCATION & AWARDS

The Glasgow School of Art · MDes Design Innovation and Transformation — Sep 2025 – Sep 2026

Course completed; degree expected November 2026. Focus: service design, user research and systems thinking.

Hunan City University · BA Environmental Design (Landscape Design) — Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

Gold, International Frontier Innovation Design Competition (2024); National Second Prize, 10th Zhongzhuang Cup (2024); 3 international, 2 national and 10+ provincial awards. Arts-led rural development project published as a Future Designer outstanding case (NCDAAL1240056).